Ideation Phase
Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Date	01 Feb 2026
Team ID	
Project Name	Strategic Product Placement & Sales Analysis
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template:

Brainstorming provides a free and open environment that encourages everyone within a team to participate in the ideation process that promotes quantity over quality. Prioritizing volume over value, out-of-the-box ideas are welcomed and built upon, and all participants are encouraged to collaborate, helping each other develop a rich amount of creative solutions.

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

Meeting Context: The team convened via a virtual whiteboard session to discuss the FMCG dataset. We agreed that simply making charts wasn't enough; we needed to solve a specific business problem using data analytics.

Selected Problem Statement: FMCG store managers struggle to understand the combined effect of store foot traffic, shelf placement (e.g., Aisle End-Cap vs. Front), and promotional discounts on final sales volume. This lack of clarity forces them to make inventory decisions rather than relying on intuition.

Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

Group 1: Data Analysis Approaches

- **Idea 1:** Build a complex Deep Learning neural network to predict exact future sales for every single product.
- **Idea 2:** Use Python (Pandas) to clean the dataset and run correlation analysis between promotions, placement, and sales volume.
- **Idea 3:** Do a simple Excel Pivot table analysis since the dataset isn't massive.

Group 2: Visualization & Reporting

- **Idea 1:** Create a huge static PDF report with Python Matplotlib/Seaborn charts.
- **Idea 2:** Create a dynamic, interactive dashboard using Tableau so managers can filter by category frameworks.
- **Idea 3:** Use Tableau Story points to specifically narrate the surprising finding that promotions actually negatively impact shelving sales.

Group 3: Delivery Mechanism (The Final Product)

Template

Brainstorm & idea prioritization

Use this template in your own brainstorming sessions so your team can unleash their imagination and start shaping concepts even if you're not sitting in the same room.

- **10 minutes** to prepare
- **1 hour** to collaborate
- **2-8 people** recommended

Before you collaborate

A little bit of preparation goes a long way with this session. Here's what you need to do to get going.

10 minutes

- **Team gathering**
  Define who should participate in the session and send an invite. Share relevant information or pre-work ahead.
- **Set the goal**
  Think about the problem you'll be focusing on solving in the brainstorming session.
- **Learn how to use the facilitation tools**
  Use the Facilitation Superpowers to run a happy and productive session.

Open article →

1 Define your problem statement

What problem are you trying to solve? Frame your problem as a How Might We statement. This will be the focus of your brainstorm.

5 minutes

PROBLEM
How might we
Strategic Product Placement Analysis**?**

Key rules of brainstorming
To run an smooth and productive session

- Stay in topic.
- Encourage wild ideas.
- Defer judgment.
- Listen to others.
- Go for volume.
- If possible, be visual.

Retail store managers find it difficult to understand how **product placement, store foot traffic, and promotional discounts** affect product sales.

Many decisions are made based on **assumptions instead of data analysis**

Lack of proper tools makes it hard to identify **sales patterns and trends**.

An **interactive analytics solution** is required to help managers make better decisions.

2 Brainstorm

10 minutes

- Analyze sales data using Python.
- Study impact of product placement on sales.
- Analyze effect of store foot traffic.
- Evaluate promotional discounts on sales.
- Create interactive dashboards using Tableau.
- Use charts to visualize sales trends.
- Build a Flask web portal for the dashboard.
- Provide insights for retail managers.

Mayur Dobariya	Analyze the dataset using Python and Pandas to clean and preprocess retail sales data	Perform Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA) to identify patterns between product placement and sales.
Neha Gandhare	Study the impact of promotional discounts on product sales performance	Analyze how store foot traffic zones influence product visibility and sales volume
Tejas Mahajan	Build a Tableau Story to explain insights like promotion impact and demographic trends.	Build a Tableau Story to explain insights like promotion impact and demographic trends.
Mayuresh Kurlapkar	Create interactive dashboards using Tableau to visualize sales insights.	Develop charts such as bar charts, scatter plots, and heatmaps for data analysis.

3 Group ideas

Take turns sharing your ideas while clustering similar or related notes as you go. Once all sticky notes have been grouped, give each cluster a sentence-like label. If a cluster is bigger than six sticky notes, try and see if you and break it up into smaller sub-groups.

20 minutes

TIP
Add customizable tags to sticky notes to make it easier to find, browse, organize, and categorize important ideas as themes within your mural.

Mind map

Team members shared their ideas one by one and discussed possible solutions to the problem statement.

Similar ideas were grouped together into clusters such as **Data Analysis, Visualization, and Web Application**

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Notes related to **Tableau dashboards and charts** were grouped under *Visualization.*

Ideas related to **Flask web portal and dashboard integration** were grouped under *Web Application.*

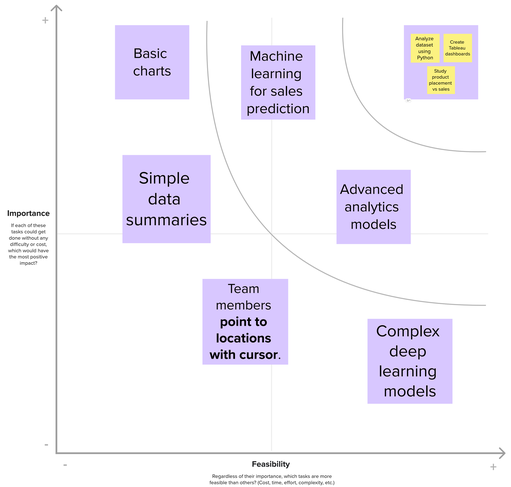
Each cluster was given a clear label to represent the main theme.

4 Prioritize

Your team should all be on the same page about what's important moving forward. Place your ideas on this grid to determine which ideas are important and which are feasible.

20 minutes

TIP
Participants can use their cursors to point at where sticky notes should go on the grid. The facilitator can confirm the spot by using the laser pointer holding the **H key** on the keyboard.



After you collaborate

You can export the mural as an image or pdf to share with members of your company who might find it helpful.

Quick add-ons

- **Share the mural**
  Share a view link to the mural with stakeholders to keep them in the loop about the outcomes of the session.
- **Export the mural**
  Export a copy of the mural as a PNG or PDF to attach to emails, include in slides, or save in your drive.

Keep moving forward

- **Strategy blueprint**
  Define the components of a new idea or strategy.
  Open the template →
- **Customer experience journey map**
  Understand customer needs, motivations, and obstacles for an experience.
  Open the template →
- **Strengths, weaknesses, opportunities & threats**
  Identify strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats (SWOT) to develop a plan.
  Open the template →

Need some inspiration?
See a finished version of this template to kickstart your work.
Open example →